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FRELIMO Chief On Independence

"WE WANT PEOPLE'S POWER IN MOZAMBIQUE"



(Left) Mozambique Liberation Front (FRELIMO) President SAMORA MOISES MACHEL and (right) victorious FRELIMO troops. Mozambique will become officially independent of Portugal on June 25.

After more than a decade of armed struggle, on June 25, Mozambique, seven times the size of its former colonizer, Portugal, with an estimated population of 8,900,000 souls, becomes independent. Separated from most of Africa by colonialism, the Republic of Mozambique will now take its rightful place among the independent nations of Africa.

The Mozambique Liberation Front (FRELIMO) indisputably led the armed struggle for the freedom of Mozambique from its formation on June 25, 1962. On June 25, 1975, FRELIMO formerly takes over the reigns of government with the wholehearted and total support of the Mozambique masses.

In celebration of this historic occasion THE BLACK PANTHER makes available to its readers the following interview with Samora Moises Machel, president of FRELIMO, who will become president of independent Mozambique on June 25, 1975. This interview appears in the June issue of the magazine *Africa*, published in London:

AFRICA: Since the formation of FRELIMO in 1962, it has been a liberation front. What changes do you believe will be necessary after independence to change FRELIMO from a front into a party?

MACHEL: FRELIMO has won great prestige because it is an organization with clear structures and a clear and well defined line. It is an organization which has its work in the midst of the masses; it derives its consciousness from the masses. It is a front, to the

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